



Puppy Foundations

Premium practice worksheet

PUPPY FOUNDATIONS • LESSON 06

Start alone-time practice before you need it.

Use this worksheet to create short, calm independence reps so your puppy learns that brief separation is safe and predictable.

TRAINER NOTE

Tiny, boring wins matter more than long, hard reps.

START HERE

Dog: _____

Date: _____

Owner: _____

Best reward: _____

1 What success looks like

By the end of this lesson, the owner has a starting duration for calm alone-time practice and a plan for repeating it successfully.

2 Practice plan

1

Set up for success

Meet your puppy's needs before practice and use a calm routine, not a dramatic exit.

2

Test a tiny absence

Step away for only a few seconds and return before your puppy struggles.

3

Record body language

Watch for pacing, barking, scratching, or inability to settle.

4

Repeat the easy win

Use the longest duration your puppy can handle calmly three times in a row.



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3 Supplies and setup

Supplies needed

- ☐ Crate, pen, or puppy-proof room
- ☐ Safe chew or food toy
- ☐ Phone or camera to observe body language
- ☐ Notebook or practice log

Set up before you start

- ☐ Choose the easiest setup where the puppy already relaxes the best.
- ☐ Practice after exercise, potty, and a calm moment.
- ☐ Decide on one short duration to test first.

4 Alone-time baseline tracker

Date	Setup	Absence	Body lang.	Recovery	Next step

5 5-day practice micro plan

Day 1

Set baseline

Find the easiest version and keep it calm.

Day 2

Repeat wins

Practice the same setup until it looks smooth.

Day 3

Add one tiny step

Add only one small challenge if yesterday

Day 4

Hold or simplify

If your puppy struggled, make today easier.

Day 5

Review notes

Choose the safest next step from your log.



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6 Common mistakes and quick fixes

Common mistakes

- Leaving for too long “to see what happens.”
- Using exciting departure rituals.
- Increasing duration after only one good rep.
- Practicing when the puppy is already overtired or under-stimulated.

If this happens, try this

- If the puppy barks quickly, shorten the rep and simplify the setup.
- If the puppy does better with a chew, use it while you build the skill.
- If the puppy panics, pause training and get professional support.

7 Ready to progress?

- ☐ I know my puppy's easiest alone-time setup.
- ☐ I have a baseline absence duration.
- ☐ I am tracking body language, not just noise.
- ☐ I know when to hold, increase, or reduce the next rep.

HOMEWORK

Practice one to two calm alone-time sessions per day for five days. Only increase time if the previous duration looked easy and repeatable.

8 Owner reflection

Biggest win: _____

What made it easier: _____

What should I repeat tomorrow: _____

QUESTIONS FOR YOUR FITDOG TRAINER

What should I make easier? _____

What should I practice again? _____

What is the next realistic step? _____